ಳೆಗಳ ಸಮಸ್ಯೆಗಳನ್ನು ಬಿಚ್ಚಿಟ್ಟ ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿಗಳು

ಮಕ್ಕಳ ದಿನಾಚರಣೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಹಕ್ಕು ಆಯೋಗಕ್ಕೆ ಸಲ್ಲಿಕೆ



ಪ್ರಜಾವಾಣಿ ಸಿಕ್ಕಿನಾಗ • ಆಗಸ್ಟ್ 18, 2023

ಕಾಯ್ದೆಗಳ ಅನುಷ್ಠಾನಕ್ಕೆ ನಿಷ್ಠೆ ಮುಖ್ಯ

ಮಾಲೋಚನಾ ಸಭೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ತಜ್ಞ ಪ್ರೊ.ವಿ.ಪಿ.ನಿರಂಜನಾರಾಧ್ಯ



ಹೆಣ್ಣುಮಕ್ಕಳ ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಹಕ್ಕು: ಜಾಗೃತಿ ಅಭಿಯಾನ





ಆರ್‌ಎಲ್‌ಹೆಚ್‌ಪಿ ಸಂಯೋಜನೆಯಲ್ಲಿ 'ವಿಶ್ವ ಪರಿಸರ ದಿನಾಚರಣೆ'

ಮಕ್ಕಳ ದಿನಾಚರಣೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಆಯೋಗಕ್ಕೆ ಶಿಫಾರಸು

'ಸಂಪ್ರದಾಯದ ಹೆಸರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಬಾಲ್ಯವಿ





ಬಾಲಕಾರ್ಮಿಕ ನಿರ್ಮೂಲನೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಎನ್‌ಜಿಒಗಳು ಮತ್ತು ಸರ್ಕಾರದ ಪಾತ್ರ' ಕುರಿತು ಅಂತರರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ಕಾರ್ಯಾಗಾರ



ಪ್ರಜಾವಾಣಿ

ಆಪದ ಪರಿಸ್ಥಿತಿ ದಿನಾಚರಣೆ ಯುವ ನಾಯಕತ್ವ ಸಬಲೀಕರಣ ಮತ್ತು ಕ್ರೀಡಾ ಇಲಾಖೆ ಸಹಯೋಗದಲ್ಲಿ ಆಪದ ಪರಿಸ್ಥಿತಿ ದಿನದ ಸಮಾರಂಭ

ಹೆಣ್ಣು ಮಕ್ಕಳು ಅವಕಾಶ ಸಿಕ್ಕಾಗ ಮುನ್ನುಗ್ಗಬೇಕು



ಪ್ರಜಾವಾಣಿ

'ಕಾನೂನಿನಿಂದ ಮಹಿಳೆಯರಿಗೆ ರಕ್ಷಣೆ'



ತಿ.ನರಸೀಪುರ ತಾಲ್ಲೂಕಿನ ರಂಗಾಜಾರಿಹುಂಡಿ ಗ್ರಾಮದಲ್ಲಿ ನಡೆದ ಅಂತರರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ಮಹಿಳಾ ದಿನಾಚರಣೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಮಹಿಳಾ ಸಾಧಕರನ್ನು ಸನ್ಮಾನಿಸಲಾಯಿತು

ಕನ್ನಡಪ್ರಭ

ಪರಿಸರ ಸಂರಕ್ಷಣೆಗೆ ಮುಂದಾಗಿ

ಆರ್‌ಎಲ್‌ಎಚ್‌ಪಿ ಸಂಯೋಜಕ ಶಶಿಕುಮಾರ್ ಸಲಹೆ



Act responsibly to slow down climate change, DC tells youth

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE
@Mysuru

DEPUTY Commissioner K V Rajendra urged the youths to act responsibly to prevent climate change as it can lead to deadly consequences and hamper their future.

Speaking during the national seminar on 'Youth Engage-

lege and support the government in its initiatives to protect the environment. Thirthahalli and Agumbe in Shimoga district witness good rainfall during monsoon, but due to climate change there was no rainfall for three years which caused lots for farmers. Clin can have deadly co ill hamper the

ಕನ್ನಡಪ್ರಭ

ಸರ್ಕಾರಿ ಯೋಜನೆಗಳ ಸದ್ಬಳಕೆ ಕುರಿತ ಕಾರ್ಯಕ್ರಮ ಸಂಪನ್ನ



ಶುದ್ಧ ಕುಡಿಯುವ ನೀರಿನ ಘಟಕ ಉದ್ಘಾಟನೆ

ಆರ್‌ಎಲ್‌ಎಚ್‌ಪಿ, ಕ್ಲುಬರ್ ಲುಬ್ರಿಕೇಶನ್ ವತಿಯಿಂದ ಸರ್ಕಾರಿ ಶಾಲಾ ಮಕ್ಕಳಿಗೆ ಕ್ರೈಟ್ಸನ್ ಸಾಮಗ್ರಿ ವಿತರಣೆ





ಪ್ರಜಾವಾಣಿ | Main Paper | 2024-02-28 | Page-4 | esadhvi.com

ಜಿಲ್ಲಾ ಮಟ್ಟದ ಮಕ್ಕಳ ಸಮಾಲೋಚನಾ ಕಾರ್ಯಾಗಾರ



ಇಬ್ಬರು ಮಕ್ಕಳು ಆಯ್ಕೆ

ಕಾರ್ಯಕ್ರಮಕ್ಕೆ ಚೆನ್ನೈಗೆ ಮಕ್ಕಳ ಪಂಚಾಯತ್‌ನಿಂದ ತೆರಳಲು ಸಂಘಟನೆ

ಗ್ರಾಮೀಣ ಮಟ್ಟದಲ್ಲಿ ಮಹಿಳಾ ಮತ್ತು ಮಕ್ಕಳ ರಕ್ಷಣಾ ಕಾವಲು ಸಮಿತಿ ಚುರುಕಾಗಿ ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡಲಿ: ವೆಂಕಟೇಶ್



ಆರೋಗ್ಯ

ಪ್ರಕೃತಿಯನ್ನು ಪೂಜಿಸಿ, ಗೌರವಿಸಿ: ಉಮೇಶ್

ಟೆರಿಷಿಯನ್ ಕಾಲೇಜಿನಲ್ಲಿ ರಾಷ್ಟ್ರೀಯ ಮಟ್ಟದ ವಿಚಾರಸಂಕಿರಣ ಉದ್ಘಾಟನೆ



'ಗ್ರಾ.ಪಂ.ಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಕಾವಲು ಸಮಿತಿ ರಚನೆ ಮಾಡಬೇಕು



ಮಹಿಳೆಯರ ಸಮಸ್ಯೆ ನಿವಾರಣೆಗೆ ಉಚಿತ ಕಾನೂನು ಸೇವೆ: ನ್ಯಾಯಾಧೀಶೆ ಜ್ಯೋತಿ ಕಾಳೆ

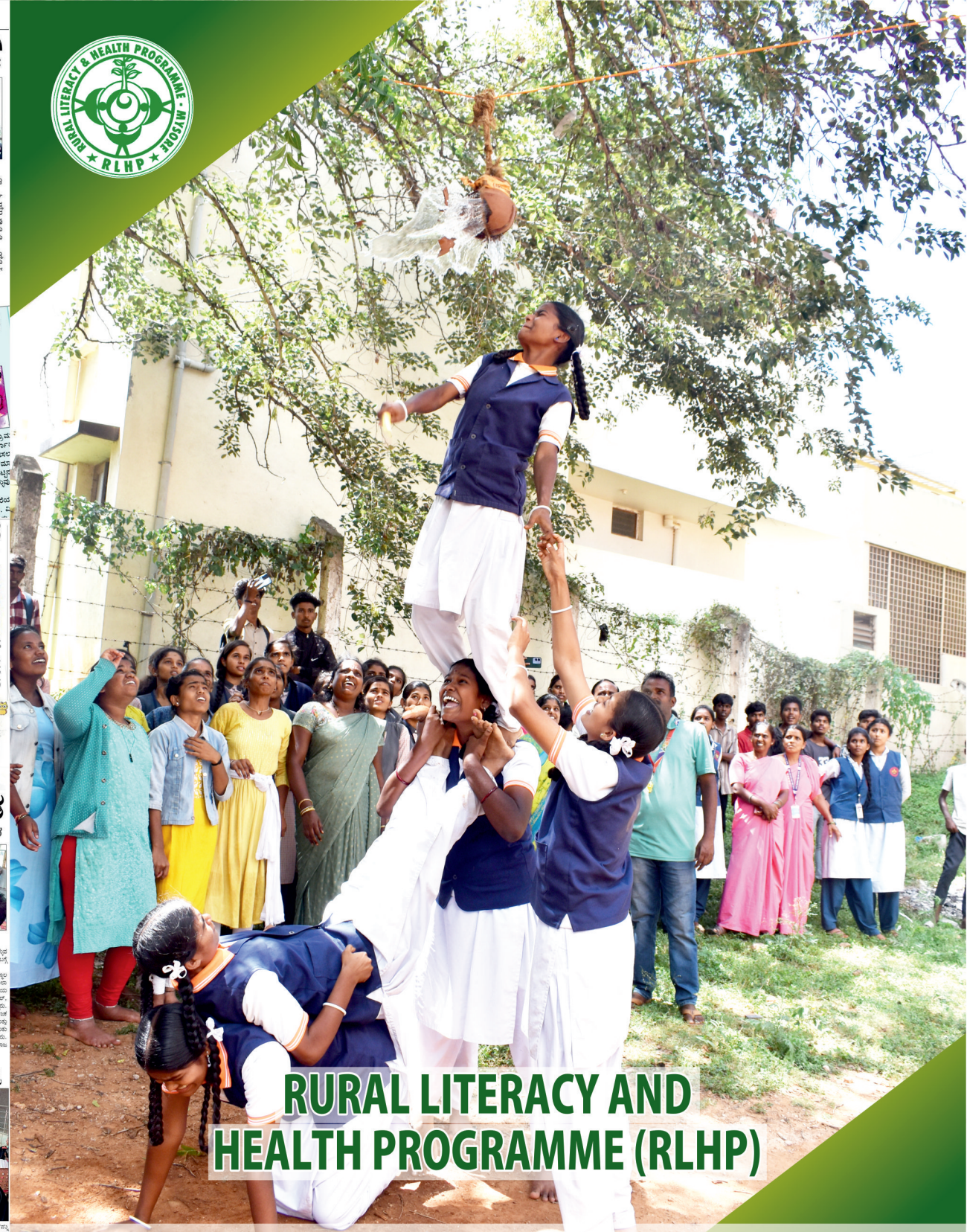


ಕೃಷಿ ಕೆಲಸದಲ್ಲಿ ಮಕ್ಕಳ ಬಳಕೆ ನಿಲ್ಲಲಿ, ಎಲ್ಲರೂ ಶಾಲೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ ಪಡೆಯಲಿ: ಡಾ. ನಿರಂಜನಾರಾಧ್ಯ





ಅಕ್ರಮ ಸಕಾಯಿ ಮಾರಾಟಗಾರರ ವಿರುದ್ಧ ಕಠಿಣ ಕ್ರಮ-ಜಚ್ಚಪ್ಪಾ



RURAL LITERACY AND HEALTH PROGRAMME (RLHP)

APRIL 2023 - MARCH 2024

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FOREWORD

On behalf of the Managing Committee of the society for Rural Literacy and Health Programme(RLHP), let me take the privilege of presenting the annual report of the year ended on 31 March 2024.Four decades back the conditions prevailed in the slums and villages of Mysore and neighboring districts were alarming due to poverty and deprivation of many kinds. The role of NGOs like RLHP cannot be written off in the process of phenomenal transformation that has been noticed today in the urban and rural communities. Its visionary leaders who have spearheaded a proactive and sustainable community development program, is a hugely significant story. This 40th annual report unveils a facet of this long journey.

Two major and serious issues that the world faces today are climate crisis and gender inequality. RLHP initiated interventions to address these issues by its new programmes namely, empowerment of adolescent girls and youth engagement in climate change. Since children's development is the core area of RLHP's interventions the annual report extensively deals with the implementation of children focused projects. It also recapitulates the story of people's transformation that was achieved through well planned and sharply focused programs on education, health and livelihood.

We were able to make tangible difference in the lives of people who are deeply disadvantaged, impoverished and marginalized, mainly due to the enduring partnership with funding organizations. We take this opportunity to express our sincere gratitude for the immense support extended by TDH(G)-BMZ,Child Fund International, Wipro cares, Azim Premji Philanthropical Initiative (APPI), Kluber Lubrications Pvt. Limited (Chem Trend Chemicals) Green Hotel, Mission Inde and many more individual donors. We look forward to their continued patronage.

Thanks to all- members of the Governing Board, Annual General Body, Director& staff, volunteers, consultants, resource persons, trainers and officials of various government departments who have been travelling with RLHP and sharing its vision all through the journey.

We pay tribute to the memory of Mr. Mathew Philip, Board member of RLHP, who stood by RLHP in its ups and downs during the past 30 years and who voiced relentlessly for the cause of human rights till his last breath on 19 December 2023.

Prof. Jose V.K
Secretary, RLHP, Mysuru.

INTRODUCTION

Aiming at the total development of people living in rural and urban areas, RLHP adopted an integrated approach in all the interventions. The interventions were designed through people participation achieved in the optimum level of child development, women empowerment, community-based health camp, and sanitation, people, and youth development.

This year, RLHP reached more than 6.5 lakh vulnerable groups of people in both rural and urban areas in 8 districts of Karnataka (Mysuru, Mandya, Chamrajnager, Bidar, Kalburagi Raichur,Davangere, and Chitradurga),significantly impacting their lives by providing education, healthcare, and livelihood opportunities.

Currently, RLHP offers diverse programs, each designed to address specific needs within our communities. We have emphasized child rights-related programs, providing care and protection to street children through shelter homes, mainstreamed child labourers, ensuring quality education, and promoting children's participation in various platforms. We offer vocational training courses with life skills and career guidance sessions for young people who have discontinued their education. We have organized capacity-building training on social and economic empowerment for women and ensured livelihood activities. They provided health and nutrition programmes to pregnant women, lactating mothers, malnourished children, and senior citizens. To promote sustainability in agriculture, they have conducted training on vermi composting, animal husbandry, organic farming, etc., for small farmers. We also involved youth groups in various environmental development programs and workshops so that they could contribute to combating climate change through innovations and sustainable practices.

Various social development schemes like the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), Social Security schemes, Food Security Act, and guarantee schemes like Anna Bhagya, Gruhalakshmi, etc., were made available to needy people through strengthening grassroots -level Groups like the Village Health Sanitation and Nutrition Committee (VHSNC), School Development and Monitoring Committee (SDMC), Women and Child Protection Committee (WCPC), Balavikasa Committees and Self-Help Groups (SHGs), etc.. The organization resumed networking with like-minded organizations like Campaign Against Child Labour (CACL), Campaign Against Child Trafficking (CACT), Karnataka Child Rights Observatory (KCRO), People's Alliance for Right to Education Act (PAPRE), Right to Food Campaign (RFC), Right to Health Campaign (RHC, Mysore District Level NGO Network (MAITHRI), Federation of Voluntary Organization Rural & Urban Development Karnataka (FEWARD-K), Mysore Slum Development Federation (RLHP Formed), Voice for Women in Slums (DWANI)and other government departments for the endorsement.

I. CHILD DEVELOPMENT

1.1 CHILDREN IN DIFFICULT CIRCUMSTANCES - (Asha Bhavana & Asha Kirana)

The organization has run the street children's shelter home for boys (Asha Kirana) and girls (Asha Bhavana) since 1990. These shelter homes aim to create avenues for children with difficult circumstances to heal from past traumas, develop essential life skills, access quality education, and empower them to envision a brighter future.



This year, 44 children have received care and protection with healthy food, education, clothing, and shelter in a safe environment. Twelve children attended elementary school, nineteen attended high school, three went to PUC, one attained a Diploma in Education, one went to a Bachelor's degree, five pursued courses in the paramedical field, and five obtained other vocational courses like plumbing, carpentry, and electrician. They receive regular counselling from a Professional Couns- ellor to maintain their psycho-social well-being. They are involved in yoga, meditation, karate, Zumba, indoor and outdoor games, and kitchen gardening as a routine.

During summer and Dussera vacations, they enjoyed learning Kamsale, Dollukunitha, Marikunitha, Mime show, Drama, Painting, Handicrafts, Papercrafts, and organic farming. They werealso giventraining on gender equality, personal hygiene, menstrual hygiene, safe and unsafe touch, health and nutrition, life skills, child marriage, child labour, child rights, children's participation, and other social issues. Kids participated enthusiastically in extracurricular activities and athletics at school, winning prizes in volleyball, quizzes, Kamsale, and mono act. Three boys this year received good grades in their 10th exams. After completing the vocational training course, two boys and two girls started working, earning Rs. 10000 to Rs.16000/- Per month and leading a dignified life.



I am Gagan (Name Changed) 20 years old, and I live in Bangalore. With my elder brother, I was wandering in the streets of Mysuru. At that time, I was six years old. My father expired, and my mother was doing street cleaning work. She was an alcoholic and never took care of us. RLHP picked us from this situation &provided Shelter for us at Ashakirana Shelter Home, where we got shelter, good food, clothing, education, and necessary care along with Psycho-Social support.

I was interested in my studies; I used to draw and participate in extracurricular activities. I got good marks in 10th. Then, with personal guidance, I opted for a vocational training course. I completed my electrician and plumbing training in 2023. Six months ago, I joined the maintenance department of St. Johns Medical College Hospital as an electrician and alsoI do part-time work after my duty hours. I am earning nearly Rs. 22,000 per month. My dream is to have my ownhouse in Mysuru and also support needy people. Ashakirana given me new life with: love, care, and affection. Today, I am leading an independent & dignified life because of RLHP, and am grateful to them.

Fiveyears old, Payal (Name Changed) and her sister used to roam in the streets with picking up garbage when their mother went for cleaning work at nearby a hotel. Seeing the little girls wandering around the street with all their filthy clothes and limbs, RLHP staff, through CWC, brought them to the Ashabhavana-girls' shelter home. In home they received shelter, food, clothing, education, and overall development.. Their mother was missing; we couldn't find her, even after the several efforts.Payal, who excelled in education, completed her training as a lab technician. After completing the course, she joined in NarayanaHrudayalaya and became self-reliant. Initially, she worked as a lab technician, and now she has been promoted to Public Relations Officer at Narayana Health Care. She helps others as much as she can and is grateful to RLHP &those who have supported her in reaching her goal

1.2. CHILD PARTICIPATION AND DEVELOPMENT

Eradication of Child Labour

This year also, Child Labour Learning Centres (CLLC) and Supplementary Education Centres continue to function in 80 villages in Bidar and Kalaburagi Districts



of North Karnataka. This center runs on community-owned infrastructure with the support of community leaders and the Panchayath to bring sustainability to the Right-To-Education (RTE) initiatives. RLHP has trained local volunteer teacher's to motivate former child labourers and helped them enroll in formal schools through joyful learning. As a result, 746 children were mainstreamed from child labour centres to schools, and 45 villages have been able to declare themselves child-labour-free.

Child Rights Clubs (CRC)



Child Rights Clubs (CRCs) have significantly impacted the community. There are one hundred and sixty-six child rights clubs & in that, we have more than 15000 members. Through different trainings and workshops this year, children were oriented on child rights and the importance of the children's club, UNCRC, POC SO Act, JJ Act, RTE, etc. As a result, CRC members have actively participated in various platforms at the schools, Panchayath, Community, Taluka, and district levels programs like Children Grama Sabha, Accessing Government Development Scheme, Press Meet, Children Mela, Summer Camp, Anti-Child Labour Day programmes, etc.



In November 2023, a representative from the Child Rights Club held a press conference in Gundlupete, Basavakalyana, and Chincholi Taluk, where they spoke candidly about various issues, including unemployment and poverty. They highlighted how these problems hinder children's access to their rights, leading to child labour, child marriages, and abuse. Additionally, they expressed concern over the inadequate infrastructure and the substandard quality of education in government schools. Two children representatives were selected to take part in a state-level Children parliament program in a district level Children's Parliament program held at RLHP Mysore in October 2023.\

Children's Special Grama Sabhas.



Through the initiatives of Children's Clubs and with the support of RLHP this year, 28 Gram Panchayaths organized Children's Special Grama Sabhas. During these meetings, children confidently voiced their concerns on issues such as ragging, corporal punishment, child marriages, child labor, and inadequate school infrastructure in front of government officials and people representatives. As a result of these efforts, 37 schools were renovated, drinking water facilities were installed in 45 schools, additional teachers were hired for 30 schools, and 12 mid-day meal kitchens were refurbished. New buildings for mid-day meals were constructed in 6 schools. Furthermore, transportation facilities were provided to 11 villages; electricity connections were secured for three schools, and various other infrastructure improvements, including drinking water, playgrounds, school compounds, drainage and sanitation facilities, libraries, benches, desks, and plates, were made by the Panchayaths and other relevant departments.

Playful vacations to children; Summer & Dussera camps:

Educational & recreational camps were conducted during Summer School vacations and Dussera holidays. More than 5000 children from all 130 villages and 25 slums benefited from the camps. On this platform, they exhibited their talents and improved their skills by engaging in extracurricular activities. These camps prevented children from migrating with their parents and from becoming child labourers.



Eight-year-old Anasuya (Name Changed) did not attend school and she takes care of her three younger sisters while her parents were working. Rather than playing and attending school, she spent her days feeding her sisters, washing dishes, and helping her mother with other household chores. Although she was initially enrolled in school, her education was disrupted by her family's migration, making schooling seem like a distant dream.

After identifying Anasuya situation, RLHP held frequent sessions with her parents to emphasize the importance of education and helped them access various social security schemes. Once Anjali began attending the Child Learning and Literacy Centre (CLLC) in the mornings, she also brought her sister along. For eight months, she participated in joyful learning sessions at the centre, where she improved her speaking skills, maintained personal hygiene, followed a study plan, and became motivated to return to school. Her foundation test score at CLLC was strong. Last year, Anasuya turned 10, and in July 2023, she was re-enrolled in the fifth standard. Now she is attending school regularly & joyfully enjoying her childhood with friends.

Establishment of model government schools with advanced facilities:

This year, RLHP, with the support of Kluber Lubrications and Chem Trend, took measures to make the learning environment more child-friendly in government schools at Mysuru. Selected government schools were improved with facilities like furniture, toilets, sports equipment, water purifiers, computers, LCD projectors, drum sets and sanitary pad burning machine. Schools got wall painted on the Right to Education Act, hygiene practices, etc. Around 1800 children were provided with school kits-bags, notebooks, clothing, and stationery. Provided children regular health awareness training, including training on menstrual hygiene, safe and unsafe touch, personal hygiene, communicable and non communicable disease, etc.



Consequently, there has been an increase in the number of students enrolled in government schools; the quality of education has improved; digital learning and computer literacy have been strengthened; and children are encouraged to finish their education, thereby reducing the possibility of school dropouts, child labourers, and child marriages.

Engaging Children for Environment protection (Green Teams)

RLHP initiated "Green Teams" in 25 schools to teach responsibility towards the environment among children. They learned about recycling, reducing waste, conserving energy and water, and choosing eco-friendly alternatives through training.

This year, experts conducted over 30 training sessions for the children. As a result, the children are now promoting eco-friendly clothing and paper bags in their schools and villages. They have also adopted practices such as solid waste management, composting, and organic farming, with kitchen gardens established



at their schools and Anganwadicenters. These efforts have led to the harvest of 13 kg of radishes, 25 kg of brinjal, 19 kg of beans, 29 kg of tomatoes, chilies, papayas, and green leafy vegetables. The vegetables are grown without chemicals or pesticides and are used in midday meals, enhancing the food's nutritional value and flavor.

1.3 MYSURU CHILD DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

A new initiative of our organization is the Mysore Child Development Programme, implemented in 17 locations under Mysore City Corporation, covering 1234 children and a total of 3,13,877 populations. Under this programme, RLHP focuses on the health, education, livelihood, and child protection aspects of exclusive, deprived, and vulnerable children and women. Numerous initiatives and awareness campaigns were carried out, and about 2, 59,538 beneficiaries were made aware of social issues and social security programmes through different events conducted in working locations. About 1200 children participated in health, education, and child protection programmes. Twenty-three girls and women received tailoring training, and few have begun self-employment, and few are seeking jobs. Twenty-five children who received computer training helped them to develop their skills. Through the VLCPC meeting, the relevant authorities reported and settled seven cases of domestic abuse, two child marriages, and five cases of school dropouts. Forty-one students who received support for education are now employed, earning, and leading dignified lives.



Sudarshan (Name Changed), has been a part of Child Fund for 7 years, he suffers from Type 1 diabetes, requiring two insulin shots daily. Living with his single disabled mother, and his sister Lakshmi, Siddharth's education was hindered by his medical condition and financial struggles. Initially studying private School, he faced challenges in continuing his education. During home visit our team identified his health issue and spoken with his mother about available treatments and convinced her to send him school, later on our team enrolled him in Govt School near to his house and contacted with Local PHC doctor about his health issues and regular insulin shot and they agreed to give free treatment. Now child is going to school regularly & he is happy & improving his health condition. RLHP team doing continues follow up.

2. WOMEN EMPOWERMENT

2.1 TRAINING ON SOCIAL ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

Currently, 235 women groups are functioning in RLHP intervention areas. They had different trainings on women's rights, domestic violence and legal facilities, reproductive health and sanitation, the significance of SHG, self-employment, gender equality, financial management, entrepreneurial activities, social development, etc. To encourage them to start small businesses and entrepreneurial activities, an exposure visit was conducted to SABALA, Vijayapura. This year, 21 women from 15 groups were identified and provided financial support to start income-generating activities such as animal husbandry, petty shops, and small tailoring units. Additionally, 121 women secured bank loans under the National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM) to kick start entrepreneurial ventures. These loans were used to purchase Roti machines, sewing machines, goats, and cows and to set up petty shops in the village.





Empowered women are raising their voices against social issues, especially in 15 villages. They protested against alco-

hol shops and the illegal sales of liquor, and as a result, in 8 villages, the alcohol shops were closed. They started accessing Govt schemes like National Rural Employment Guarantee programmes, National Livelihood Mission, Vishwa Karma, Matruvandana, and Gruhalakshmietc.

2.2 PSYCHO-SOCIAL SUPPORT TO WOMEN

Domestic violence, along with stressful events such as early marriage, separation, divorce, family burdens, work pressure, and complicated family situations, contribute to mental health problems among women. RLHP has addressed these issues by providing psycho-social support through individual counselling and workshops.



This year, 25 awareness workshops were conducted, helping women recognize how they were unknowingly experiencing mental strain due to pressures from their families and communities. Through these workshops, they learned preventive measures and stress management techniques from experts. As a result, five family disputes were resolved through counselling services, and women's groups successfully addressed five cases of domestic violence. Mental health issues are now being prioritized, with women receiving guidance and counselling and consulting mental health professionals when necessary.

2.3 INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY

RLHP organized the International Women's Day programme this March in five working regions: Mysuru Urban, Mysuru Rural, Bidar, Kalburagi, and Gundlapete. More than 1,200 womenactively participated in these programmes. The sports activities were conducted for the women, and prizes were distributed to the winners. In this event, they celebrated the achievements of women in all fields through songs, dances, and dramas.The cultural event also depicted the impact of gender stereotypes, local culture, and folk. Organized the exhibition & provided a platform for women to showcase their homemade products, including chutney



pudi, snacks, rotis, lamb dishes, crafted cloths, embroidered dresses, and handicrafts.

The motivational speeches by distinguished guests increased women's self-confidence in making choices and decisions, having control over their lives, and raising voices on social issues. It enhanced their knowledge of the role of women in social transformation through economic growth and political stability.

Chikkaningadalli village, located in Chincholi taluk, has 800 households and a population of around 1,200. The majority of the residents are daily wage workers. Alcoholism was a significant issue, leading to a lack of peace within families and an increase in quarrels and domestic violence, with women and children being the primary victims. Women were initially afraid to speak out about the problem. However, various capacity-building training helped boost their confidence, enabling them to stand up and protest against the issue.

They vocalized the issue in front of officers in the taluk level mass contact program which was held at Chandapur on September 9, 2023, and demanded to close the liquor shops permanently. The officers recorded the incidents, and Mr. Jettappa B. Belur, the inspector of the Excise Department, assured them he would take action. Within a few days after the program, the Excise department raided illegal liquor-selling shops and shut them permanently.

3. YOUTH DEVELOPMENT

3.1 EMPOWERMENT OF ADOLESCENT GIRLS

RLHP continued providing school and community-based intervention programmesto empower adolescent girls. In the reporting period, 2164 adolescent girls underwent training on menstrual and personal hygiene, teenage pregnancy, Gender equality, Adolescent Problems, nutrition, the importance of girl children's education, physical and mental health, personality development, gender discrim-



ination, and life skills. They became capable of meeting the challenges faced during puberty.They were also sensitized on the effects of child marriage and child labour and educated on POCSO Act, Child Line, and legal support.

As a result, adolescent girls succeeded in convincing their families to continue their higher education. They learned Mime shows, Kamsale, Dool, Kolata dance forms, and street plays and performed on various platforms. They filed the complaint in CHILDLINE 1098 and stopped 15 child marriages.

RIGHT TO PLAY



A unique sports event for girls to overcome the gender barrier was organized on the "Right to Play" day at Gundlupete. This event, unlike any other, was designed to promote sports and challenge gender stereotypes. Around 700 adolescent girls and youth participated in two events. Winning was not the primary goal of this event; instead, it created opportunities for the girls. This motivation extended to the girls and their teachers, inspiring them to challenge gender stereotypes and encourage participation in sports such as Kabaddi, cricket, and volleyball. As a result, [specific number] of the girls surpassed traditional gender norms by forming teams and competing in school, taluk, and district-level events.

3.2 VOCATIONAL TRAINING COURSES

To integrate underprivileged &out-of-school adolescents into mainstream opportunities, RLHP has provided a range of vocational training courses, including tailoring and embroidery, driving, and computer skills. Participants also received career guidance, life skills, soft skills, and personality development workshops, fo-



cusing on entrepreneurship, marketing, and other professional skills to enhance their job prospects.

As an impact of our vocational training programmethis year350, adolescents and youths completed vocational training, and 118 secured employment and earned between Rs. 8,000 to Rs. 20,000 per month. This achievement reflects their hard work and dedication, as well as the effectiveness of our programme in leading them toward self-reliance and a better future. The vocational training programme has provided them with skills and empowered them to take control of their lives and build a better future for themselves and their families.

3.3 YOUTH ENGAGEMENT IN CLIMATE CHANGE

RLHP's youth engagement in climate change is a beacon of hope. With 35 youth groups across the state, our primary objective of environmental protection is being actively pursued. More than 600 youths have been sensitized to environmental protection and climate science literacy this year. Their active participation in district, state, and national-level trainings and workshops, as well as national-level awareness campaigns like General Comment 26, is a testament to their commitment. Their innovative ideas for new eco-based start-ups to solve environmental pollution and sustainability are a source of encouragement and optimism.

Youths participated in various awareness programmes focused on local environmental issues, including river cleaning initiatives, solid waste management, climate change, and environmental pollution. For instance, they organized river cleaning drives in Sangam, T Narasipura, managed solid waste, and conducted



awareness campaigns on climate change in Mysuru City; they observed significant days such as World Environment Day, World Earth Day, National Youth Day, and International Youth Day and participated in Global Action Month. The climate education programme emphasized three critical strategies:knowledge, action, and advocacyto empower youth voices on climate rights.

As a result, more than a thousand saplings have been planted across the state as part of the Voice for Green Earth campaign. They submitted requests to the district administration for sustainable tourism development in the Mysuru district.

Youth have undertaken initiatives to

protect the biodiversity of Chamundi Hill, convert Gomala into a Social Forest, and establish a dedicated open library for environmental education. The Ashakirana Boys' Home has been transformed into a model for sustainable agriculture, inspiring nearby schools to create kitchen gardens to enhance food security. Additionally, the youth are working to unite like-minded individuals across the state and advocate for stronger environmental protection laws.

Youth in Action to Save Natural Heritage

The Roof Way Yojana was a development project to build a ropeway to Chamundi Hill, Mysuru, a site of historical significance and rich biodiversity. Noting the ecological impact, various environmentalists, including RLHP, opposed the project through Youth Groups. On Environment Day, June 5, 2023, the youth took a stand against the ropeway project by forming a human chain. They organized a procession through Gandhi Circle, Shivaram Pete, and Arasu Road, culminating in front of the DC Office, where they presented a memorandum to ADC Mrs. Kavitha Rajaram. The memorandum included a demand to drop the Roof Way project among its 12 requests. Following persistent efforts by the community, the government decided to cancel the project. This decision was announced at a meeting of senior officials and stakeholders in Mysuru on July 6th, as reported in the newspaper. This outcome represents a significant victory for the youth and environmentalists' advocacy.

4. PEOPLE'S DEVELOPMENT

4.1 STRENGTHENING OF EXISTING LOCAL COMMITTEES FOR SUSTAINABILITY

By conducting capacity-building-training and workshops, the organization continued its effort to strengthen existing community-based welfare committees, local authorities, and elected representatives such as the School Development and Monitoring Committee (SDMC), Village Health Sanitation and Nutrition Committee (VHSNC) Backward Region Scheme Support Group (BRSSG), Women and



Child Protection Committee (WCPC) andGramaPanchayat and Mysore Slum Dwellers Federation (MSDF), Child Marriage Prohibition Officers(CMPOs), DHWANI and RLHP formed Women groups, Small farmers group, Youth groups, and Child Right Clubs for the sustainability of development programmes and activities.

This year, RLHP organized131 trainingin which a total of 3790 members participated actively and learned about their roles in community development, the Right to Education Act, Child Marriage Act, Child Labour Act, Domestic Violence Act, United Nations Convention of Rights of the Child (UNCRC), Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (POCSO), Panchayath Raj Act, 73rd Amendment, Integrated Child Development Schemes (ICDS) and other social security Schemes.

4.2 MASS CONTACT PROGRAMMES

Mass Contact Programme (MCP) is considered one of the good initiatives of RLHP, where several thousands of people liaise with different government departments to benefit from social security and community development schemes. It is held under different names in different working regions, such as accessing Government Development Schemes (AGDS), Labour Rights Orientation Programmes, Application Melas, and CBO Interface Meetings.

This year, one hundred sixty-five such programmes were held at the village and taluk levels. More than 8000 people expressed issues prevalent in their villages, such as the need for safe drinking water, alcohol issues, transportation problems, drainage, child marriages, child labour, Primary Health Care centers, schools, and Anganwadi infrastructure, Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Schemes (MGNREGA), etc. and submitted mass applications and petitions. Government officials of different departments such asGramaPanchayath, Taluk Panchayath,Tahsildar, Block Education Officers (BEO), Exercise Department, Labor Department, District Health Officer (DHO),Child Development Project Officer (CDPO), and District Child Protection Officer (DCPO) were responded to the people's problems.



As a result, Community leaders took the initiative to enrol child labourers and school dropouts, monitor quality education, and resolve community problems.



Around 4000 people worked under MGNREGA. Twenty-threewomen who worked under the MGNREGA scheme got their salary, which was denied due to the intermediaries resolved with the support of Panchayath officials. Road construction was done in 9 villages; bus facilities were provided to 15 villages, 4 Anganwadi's started functioning again; drainage was constructed in several villages, and infrastructure facilities were provided to the primary health care centers and schools.

Around 18 000people were facilitated to apply for government facilities and benefits from the development schemes like Health Card / ABHA, Labour cards and kits for construction work, Gruhalakshmi,Gruhajyothi, Annabhagya, old age,widow pension, Manaswini pension, Pan card, Adhar card, Ration card and income caste certificate, Vishwakarma scheme, etc.

Annurkeri Panchayat in Gundlupete Taluk consists of about 100 households. At the village entrance, a school, a Panchayat office, an Anganwadi, and a health sub-centre are all situated within the same compound. However, a poorly maintained drainage system in front of the school led to improper water flow, creating sanitation issues that negatively impacted the children's health and education. Despite repeated discussions by the Anganwadi and school staff with the Panchayat, the Gram Panchayat took no action for years.

RLHP stepped in to raise awareness within the community and encouraged collective action. During a mass contact program, community members directly voiced their concerns about the issue to the officials. As a result, within a month, the Gram Panchayat addressed the problem by constructing box drainage, effectively resolving the situation.

4.3 SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE

Most rural households are predominantly small farmers who earn solely from agriculture. To promote livelihood with sustainability in agriculture, RLHP formed 89 small farmers groups and continued to work with 903 members by providing training on organic farming, animal husbandry horticulture, multi-cropping, Vermi composting, and organizing exposure visits. A total of 116 farmers adopted complete organic farming and stepped towards sustainability.

The Farmers against Child Labour movement was held to inspire farmers to eradicate child labour in the agricultural field.

5. COMMUNITY-BASEDHEALTH & SANITATION

5.1 HEALTH CAMPS AND MELAS

The aim of conducting the health camps and health melas is to provide doorstep health facilities to people in need and create awareness in public awareness of communicable and non-communicable diseases, the importance of nutrition, and sanitation.This will also provide them a platform to apply for health-related schemes like Ayushman Bharath, Matu Vandana, etc.

This year, RLHP conducted 300 health camps and four health melas, through which 7659 patients benefited. The camps covered obstetrics and gynecology, neonatal and pediatric, ophthalmology, dermatology, Dental, general cold, fever, cough, diabetes, immunization, blood pressure, thyroid, tuberculosis, anemia, geriatric, and mental health issues. Significant impacts from this were52 patients underwent cataract surgery, 65 people underwent dental treatment, 24 women were identified as diabetic and started medication, 168 Diabetic patients have been continuing therapy in primary health care centers and tertiary hospitals, three patients identified with TB, and on regular medication, four patients with mental illness on regular follow-up, 53 senior citizens started with BP medication. Eightgynecology patients were referred to tertiary hospitals for further treatment.



Pregnant women were facilitated to apply for the Matruvandana scheme.

This year, 857 people received first aid treatment from trained health animators, and 351 patients were sent to the nearest hospital for further treatment.

5.2 HEALTH AWARENESS



RLHP conducted Reproductive and Child Health training in villages, and 1105 women participated and discussed topics about menstruation, ANC/PNC, safety methods, family planning, prevention and management of RTI/STD/AIDS, safe motherhood, government health schemes, infant care, the importance of breastfeeding, immunization, gender and health, and my body and my rights as a result108 pregnant women received mother cards and benefits. Women started to prefer hospital deliveries for safety, came out of the myths related to pregnancy and delivery, started using safety measures to prevent sexually transmitted diseases, and increased knowledge on personal hygiene, toilet usage, waste management, etc. Various workshops enhanced the responsibility and participation of VHNSC members, Balavikasa, ASHA, and Anganawadi workers in community health and sanitation.

5.3 NUTRITION FOOD DEMONSTRATION PROGRAMME

RLHP has consistently tried to eradicate malnutrition among women and children.This year, 235 malnourished children were selected and provided supplementary food like protein mixture powder and Spirulina chikki. Raised awareness among parents about the importance of children's health and the local availability of nutritious food and guided them on child development with the support of a children's health specialist. The staff monitored the children's weight every month in the presence of their mothers so they could easily observe the continuous change and follow



the steps taught by the experts.

Trained mothers prepared nutritious food for the family by including pulses, grains, vegetables, fruits, and meat. As a result, improvement is noticed in the health of malnourished children and women.

I am Radha (Name Changed), 24,a married woman from Hosahalli Village, Mysuru. Since I was pregnant, many rituals have been done in our house. The health animator of RLHP visited our home and invited me to attend RCH training, where I learned about the importance of nutritious food and the mother card and clarified my doubts regarding pregnancy. Accordingly, I used to have food on time and get immunizations. On a full moon day, I had labor pain, but they did not take me to the hospital due to superstitious beliefs. I informed the health animator. The health animator and Asha worker visited our house, sensitized to superstition, which may cause problems for both mother and child. Immediately, they shifted me to the hospital. I had a safe delivery at the hospital, and right now, we both are healthy. I thank RLHP for the timely support and guidance.

6. STAFF DEVELOPMENT



The practical implementation of all the project activities relies on the quality performance and commitment of the staff. Therefore, RLHP always pays critical attention to ensuring that our staff can improve the quality of their work.

This year, RLHP has organized capacity-building workshops, refresher training, and staff exposure visits. These programmes mainly focused on enhancing staff knowledge and skills in result-based activities in the community through planning, implementation, and evaluation methods. Staff enriched their understandingofthe Child Safeguarding Policies, Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition, and Redressal) Act (Child Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (POCSO), Right to Education Act, Panchayath Raj Act, Report writing skills, vision building, sustainable agriculture, Feminist movement, and its challenges, Management of Information system in concerned apps like Gunjan etc.

To address staff grievances, RLHP has a Prevention of Sexual Harassment Committee (POSH), which meets once every three months. External training programmes and staff yearly appraisals further increased staff productivity and creativity. The team was also inspired to make productive and positive changes through the monthly review meetings.

7. NETWORKING



RLHP maintained its network with all like-minded organizations, government departments, national and international developmental organizations, CACL, FE-VORD-K, DWANI, MYTHRI, MahilaD-owrjanyaVirodiOkkuta community-based organizations, and so on. Several state and national network-building sessions with various organizations saw active group participation. We are honored to continue as State Convener for CACL (K), an organization dedicated to achieving an India free of child labor.

This year, an alternate Child Labour Law in the form of an alternate Child Labour System (abolition, Prevention, and Rehabilitation) Bill has been drafted by CACL and presented to theState representatives. The representatives have provided their key recommendations, including the abolition of child labor up to the age of 18 years, effective utilization of the Child Labour Rehabilitation funds, and strengthening of the monitoring and judicial systems to address child labour issues efficiently. The recommendations for child labor law have been gathered from 22 former child workers. Based on the demands, a manifesto was prepared and presented to policymakers and political parties before the 2024 general elections.

A conversant meeting regarding the child sexual assault incident of Sagara, Karnataka, was held with CACL partners, and a memorandum was submitted to the Government through each District Commissioners (DC) demanding a stringent investigation. Additionally, it is advised that female staff members be assigned to the girls' hostel and that the Child Protection Policy (CPP) be adhered to properly in every hostel.

The two-day consultation programme on Bal Adhikar Sammelan—Interface with people representatives, Bachhon Ki Baatcheet Jan PrathinidhiyonKe Saat—was arranged by CACL, RLHP, and HAQ—the Centre for Child Rights organization—at the Indian Social Institute in New Delhi. During a two-day programme, 29 children from 9 states around the country actively learned about their rights, the current situation of children in India, and the efficacy of laws and policies, and prepared recommendations to the government.

8. OTHER EVENTS

8.1 MUTUAL EXCHANGE VISIT ZIMBABWE & INDIA



RLHP and Zimbabwe are jointly implementing a project funded by Terre des hommes (G) to eradicate child labor in the agricultural sector. This year, from 22nd to 29th May 2023, an Indian team of the Deputy Regional Coordinator - South Asia, tdh, the Project Director, the District Coordinator, and a youth representative of RLHP visited the project in Zimbabwe. The team was facilitated to visit the incubation centre and Livelihood initiative of Goat Farming, visit the villages and schools, and interact with government officials, children, and community members. The Indian team has learned about good practices like livelihood support for goat farming, which is very much in line with the project focus on the agriculture sector and the collaborations of the project team with the agriculture and horticulture departments.

From March 16th to 22nd, 2024, a team of five members from Zimbabwe, including the Coalition against Child Labour in Zimbabwe (CACL-Z) and the Labour Ministry of Zimbabwe, visited the project region in North Karnataka. The team was enabled to interact with child labourers, stakeholders, government representatives, and communities. They witnessed various programmes, especially the Children's Special Grama Sabha, Internation-

al Women's Day celebrations, vocational training programmes, and the initiation of entrepreneurial activities like dairy farming. They also participated in discussion sessions organized at Christ University Bangalore and the International Workshop held at Central University, Kalburgi. They shared learning and perspectives about practices like interface meetings, school development and monitoring committees, and other observations made during the visit.

8.2 FOUNDER'S DAY PROGRAMME



Lt. Mr. Joy Maliekal, Founder of the Rural Literacy and Health Programme (RLHP), has played a crucial role in bringing far-reaching transformation in people's lives through developmental programmes and activities for the last three and a half decades. In his memory, RLHP is organizing meaningful programmes and seminars to carry forward his legacy by reaching out to more deprived sections of society and showcasing his inspiring model to the new generation.

On 6th July 2023, on his birthday, the organization arranged a National level Seminar on "Youth Engagement in Climate Action" in collaboration with the Teresian College, Mysuru. Padma Shri Smt. SalumaradaThimmakka, an environmentalist, inaugurated this seminar. Dr. Rajendra K.V., I.A.S., Deputy Commissioner Mysore, was a chief guest. A session on "The Science behind Addressing Climate Change" was conducted by Ms. Nisha D'Souza, founder and director of Eco Niche. Another session on "Simple steps towards carbon-neutral future" was taken by Mr. U N Ravi Kumar, a well-known envi-ronmentalist in Mysuru. More than 300 college students, teachers, faculty members, researchers, youth organizations, development professionals, and media professionals participated in this seminar.

CONCLUSION

We wish to record our sincere gratitude to all our funding partners, individual donors, and Government officials from different departments, and Resource persons, Especially the RLHP board Members, RLHP staff team, friends, and well-wishers for their valuable support and encouragement during the year. If not for their support, the achievements of the year 2023 – 2024 would have been difficult. Significant inroads have been made in Child Rights and Participation, Women Empowerment, Community Health and Sanitation, People Development, Protection of the Environment, Empowerment of Children and Communities in Backward Regions, and Natural Resource Management.

We will continue our efforts.

Thanking you....

Saraswathi
Director, RLHP.